

Kaeden Wellman

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SUMMARY

I'm a college freshman. I build software and embedded projects, teach what I build, and have been elected to leadership in every volunteer organization I've stayed with for over a year.

PROJECTS

Halle Reviews — Solo Full-Stack Build *Diane & Bruce Halle Foundation, 2026*

- AI-assisted grant review application that replaces the foundation reviewers' improvised Zoom + NotebookLM + ChatGPT workflow; each grant moves through an LOI → Application → Funded → Completed lifecycle with LLM summarization at every stage, driven by editable Markdown rubrics
- Sole developer, ~6,200 lines of TypeScript/JavaScript in three weeks: Vite + React 18 + TypeScript + Tailwind on Vercel, Node + Express on Railway, push-to-main continuous deployment
- Multi-provider LLM layer (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google) behind a single streaming SSE interface with a server-side persisted key store; real Microsoft Entra ID sign-in (MSAL + jose JWT validation) and per-user workspace persistence

Lightsaber Duel Game — Microchip DevDay Hackathon Winner *Best Project Award, 2026*

- Built a physical lightsaber dueling game linking a Microchip Curiosity board (CircuitPython, IMU, NeoPixels, LCD, audio) to a browser game via the Web Serial API
- Streamed motion data as JSON over USB serial at 10 Hz; shipped three deployable modes (classic side-by-side, first-person, combined)
- Repo: github.com/kaedenwellman/lightsaber-

Gyftloop — Co-founder *gyftloop.com · with wellmanaz*

- Live product: track birthdays and anniversaries, then receive three tailored gift ideas one week before each occasion via automated email
- Vanilla JS SPA on Vercel Edge Functions with Neon Postgres and Auth0 (PKCE, no SDK); integrated a product marketplace API for live catalog data, OpenAI embeddings for candidate reranking, and Resend for scheduled reminder emails
- Composite ranking model blends semantic similarity, price fit, and top-rated flags, with a heuristic fallback when the LLM key isn't configured

TEACHING & COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

CircuitPython Instructor — Microchip DevDay, Pima Community College *July 2026*

- Invited by the DevDay program's creator to co-lead the class after winning the hackathon; first student-to-instructor transition in the program's history
- Taught embedded CircuitPython to a class of about 25 college students, most with no prior coding experience
- Guided students through progressive hands-on projects on the Microchip PyKit Explorer board; ran one-on-one debugging sessions with students who got stuck

Commissioner, Link Crew — Arizona College Prep *2025–2026*

Volunteer Hurdle Coach *2+ years*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, JavaScript, HTML/CSS
- **AI & APIs:** Claude API, OpenAI API, prompt engineering, streaming SSE, Web Serial API
- **Web:** React, Vite, Tailwind, Node, Express, Vercel, Railway
- **Auth & Data:** Microsoft Entra ID (MSAL, JWT), Auth0 (PKCE), Neon Postgres
- **Embedded:** CircuitPython, Microchip PyKit Explorer, Microchip Curiosity board, IMU/NeoPixel/LCD peripherals
- **Tools:** GitHub, VS Code, Shopify, Google Apps Script

